



The Pre-Procedure Checklist & Hermes Cheat Sheet

You'd never start a procedure without the time-out: right patient, right site, right equipment. Give your AI setup the same respect. Keep this beside your keyboard for your first week — when a menu looks different, the official docs are the truth: hermes-agent.noursresearch.com/docs

The one rule before anything — no patient data. Ever. No names, charts, screenshots, room numbers, or stories that could identify a patient. This system runs on *your* life — learning, schedule, projects — never your patients.

The time-out — verify before you begin

☐ **Right equipment: a desktop or laptop — Mac or Windows.**

Not a phone, tablet, or Chromebook. On your own computer, your files and your AI's memory stay local — on your machine, not in someone's cloud. That is the whole point of owning your system.

☐ **Specs verified.**

Rough guide: a computer from the last ~5 years with at least 8 GB of memory and a few GB free usually does fine — the official Hermes site lists current requirements. If Hermes won't install, it's the machine's specs — not you, and not a mistake you made. A cloud option (the VPS path) is coming; meanwhile see "While you wait" on the last page.

☐ **Field prepped: one dedicated folder, nothing private inside.**

Like clearing a sterile field. Your system lives in one folder — My-Nurse-AI-OS, which the Starter Kit builds (Documents is the perfect home). No tax documents, no family photos, no work files — only what you'd be comfortable letting an assistant read, because that's exactly what it is.

☐ **Shared family computer? Separate user account.**

Your own med cart instead of a shared one — your AI work stays in its own space.

☐ **Smart habit: a fresh Gmail for your AI life.**

You don't do personal banking from the unit's charting station. A free, separate account (like yourname.ai@gmail.com) keeps personal and family email private — and its free Google Drive and Docs pair beautifully with your system later.

☐ **The one rule, memorized: no patient data. Ever.**

If you're unsure whether something counts — it counts. Leave it out.

All boxes checked? You're cleared for the procedure. Not all? Fix what you can — and even without a qualifying computer, the free course, the 55 AI mentors, the SOUL Quiz, the monthly Lamp Huddle, and the community are open to you today.

The procedure — install and configure

1

Install Hermes

- Go to the official Hermes site: hermes-agent.nousresearch.com
- Download Hermes for your computer (Mac or Windows) and follow their install steps.
- Open it. When setup asks about an AI model or provider, see the next step first — there are free and low-cost routes.

!

Permissions — give it a room, not the house

When Hermes asks for permission to access files, this is the moment that matters most:

- **Grant access ONLY to your My-Nurse-AI-OS folder** — the one from the Starter Kit. Nothing else.
- Decline anything broader — full disk, Desktop, Downloads, Photos. Granted too much by accident? Remove it in your computer's privacy settings.
- A float nurse's badge: access to the assigned unit, not every floor of the hospital. Hermes does excellent work in its unit. It has no business wandering the building.



Choose how your AI is powered — free and low-cost routes

Hermes itself is free and open-source. Any cost comes from the AI model that powers it — think of Hermes as the IV pump, free, and the model as what runs through it, metered by use. Two routes:

Route A — the Nous subscription. The simplest: one subscription, everything handled. Choose it during setup and skip the rest of this step.

Route B — Bring Your Own Keys (most cost-effective — can be nearly free). In Hermes setup, choose **Full Setup** (not the default subscription option), then **Bring Your Own Keys**. We recommend **openrouter.ai** — one free account, one API key, and a whole menu of models, including free and very low-cost ones. Then:

- Create an account at openrouter.ai and generate an API key from your dashboard.
- **Set a spending limit in OpenRouter first** — your safety rail against surprise bills. Start at a few dollars; you can always raise it.
- In Hermes setup, choose OpenRouter as your provider and paste your key.
- Pick a model — start with a free or low-cost one. Ask Hermes for something simple to confirm it works; if the answers feel weak, switch to a stronger model. Trying models costs nothing but the tokens you use.

One caution: a ChatGPT Plus or Grok subscription usually does *not* include API access — that is billed separately. The safest setup is a dedicated OpenRouter key with a spending limit you set yourself.

2

Your first conversation

Hermes works like a chat: type, press enter. You cannot break anything by chatting.

```
I'm a nurse setting up my Nurse AI OS. I'll give you my SOUL file next – treat it as my standing instructions.
```

3

Give Hermes your SOUL file

Your SOUL file comes from the SOUL Quiz at **nurse-ai-os.org** (it downloads as Core-SOUL.md, or grab the whole bundle). Attach or drag the file into the chat, or paste its contents. Then say:

```
This is my SOUL file. Treat it as my standing instructions for how to support me. Confirm what you understood about my values and boundaries.
```

Read its summary back. Correct anything wrong — corrections stick.

4

Give Hermes your Starter Kit

The Starter Kit (ZIP from nurse-ai-os.org) is the folder skeleton of your system. Unzip it somewhere you'll find again (Documents is perfect). The folder is **My-Nurse-AI-OS**. Then tell Hermes:

```
My Nurse AI OS folder is at [location]. This is where my files live: my SOUL file, my notes (03-Memory), my projects (04-Projects). Keep your work for me inside it.
```

Why these two files matter more than everything else: a powerful AI is like a powerful horse — magnificent, and dangerous without a harness. The Starter Kit and your SOUL file **are the harness**. The SOUL file gives the engine your values, your boundaries, the lines it may never cross. The Starter Kit gives it a home and a structure. Together they give the system **the heart of a nurse** — and keep the horse from running away with you. Skipping them doesn't make you faster; it makes you a passenger.

5

Build your dashboard (one prompt)

Paste this:

```
Using my SOUL file, personalize the Local HTML Life Dashboard in my starter kit (08-Integrations/Local-HTML-Life-Dashboard). Fill in my name, my top priorities in each sphere, and my first goals and habits from my quiz answers. Save it as My-Dashboard.html in my Nurse AI OS folder and tell me exactly where it is.
```

Open the file it creates in your browser and **bookmark it**. That's your station board.

Post-procedure care — working the system until it's muscle memory

You don't memorize features. You see the routine once in your mind, and your hands follow. Seven habits:

1 • Triage the task, then pick the model

Simple work — quick questions, summaries, rewrites, brainstorming — gets a **free or cheap model**. Heavy work — multi-step planning, long documents, coding, deep troubleshooting — gets a **stronger reasoning model**. Need it to look at a screenshot or diagram? Pick a **vision-capable** one. You don't call the code team for a splinter: start cheap, escalate when the task needs it.

2 • One session per topic — one chart per patient

Don't mix the budget, the side gig, and the CCRN plan in one conversation — details blend and answers get muddy. **New topic, new session.**

3 • Projects are care plans; sessions are shifts

A session is one conversation. For anything ongoing — a course you're building, a business plan, a family project — use a **Project**: a workspace where files, goals, and conversations stay together, so you never start from scratch.

4 • Call a consult — use personas

Tell Hermes who to be, and the depth and style of the answer change with it: *"Act as a plain-language tutor and explain this error step by step."* • *"Act as a startup strategist and review my plan for risks and next moves."*

5 • When unsure, ask the assistant itself

You never need the perfect prompt: *"What's the best next step?"* • *"Ask me the questions you need before we continue."* • *"Break this into simple steps."* • *"Which model should I use for this task?"*

6 • Troubleshoot with screenshots — show, don't describe

Hand over the telemetry strip instead of describing it. Share the screenshot plus: what you were trying to do, what happened instead, the exact error, and what you've already tried. **Never include API keys or passwords in a screenshot** — crop or blur them first.

7 • Steward the spend

Watch usage the way you watch supplies: spending limits on, drafts on cheap models, strong models saved for final reasoning, no huge files unless the task truly needs them.

The everyday routine — say it until your hands know it: right model for the task • new session for a new topic • a project for ongoing work • a persona for specialist output • ask when unsure • show a screenshot when stuck • escalate the model only when needed.

Post-procedure orders — five phrases that do most of the work

You say	Hermes does
"Run my morning huddle."	Asks your #1 priority, offers three ways to help
"Give me a Kardex entry for this session."	Writes a 5-line handoff note to save in 03-Memory
"Make that correction permanent."	Turns your feedback into a standing rule
"Before you start, interview me like an admission assessment."	Asks questions before big tasks instead of guessing
"Show me your plan before you do anything."	Keeps your hand on every decision

While you wait — no qualifying computer yet? You're still in.

If your current computer can't run Hermes, you've lost nothing but the installation step. Everything else is open to you today:

- **Take the free AI course** and work with the **55 free AI mentors** — CCRN and certification prep, leadership, career — they run in any browser: nurse-ai-os.org/ai-mentors.html
- **Come to the monthly Lamp Huddle** and join the community list at nurse-ai-os.org
- **Take the SOUL Quiz now** — your SOUL file will be ready and waiting the day your system is.

And hear this plainly: your participation and your voice matter to us now — not after you buy hardware. AI is coming to healthcare with or without nursing at the table. The nurses preparing today are the ones who will lead that change instead of being led by it. **You are the future Florence Nightingales — the ones who will decide how care intelligence is born.**

If you feel lost

Normal. You only need the next step, never the whole map. Skip what confuses you, and bring questions to the monthly Lamp Huddle — every nurse there started exactly where you are.

Agents propose. Humans judge. Nurses steward.

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